

TrustLock Admin Training Manual

Internal Operations & Procedures Guide

Version 1.0 — Confidential

For authorized admin staff only. Do not distribute.

Table of Contents

1. Welcome & Role Overview
2. Chain of Command & Hierarchy
3. Getting Started — First Login & Setup
4. Admin Dashboard Navigation
5. Your Primary Responsibility: Messaging
6. Escalation Protocol
7. What Admin Staff CANNOT Do
8. What Chief Admins CAN Do
9. AI Tools Available to You
10. Shared Inbox Protocol
11. Action Logging & Accountability
12. Understanding Transactions & Escrow
13. Understanding Disputes
14. Compliance & KYC Basics
15. Blockchain Proof Awareness
16. Document Management
17. Security & Session Management
18. Common Scenarios & Responses
19. Glossary
20. Emergency Procedures

1. Welcome & Role Overview

Welcome to TrustLock. You are part of a platform that provides escrow-based payment protection for cross-border B2B transactions. Your role as Admin Staff is critical to maintaining trust between buyers and vendors.

As Admin Staff, your primary function is to serve as the communication bridge between platform users (buyers and vendors) and the chain of command (Chief Admins). You are the first point of contact for all user inquiries.

IMPORTANT: Admin Staff do NOT have authority to settle disputes, approve payouts, manage compliance flags, or make financial decisions. These actions are reserved for Chief Admins only.

Your core responsibilities:

1. Respond to user messages promptly and professionally
2. Escalate issues to the chain of command with clear context
3. Maintain awareness of ongoing transactions and their status
4. Follow the anonymity protocol — users only see your agent alias (e.g., TL-Agent-XXXX)
5. Log all actions with justifications when required

2. Chain of Command & Hierarchy

TrustLock operates with a strict hierarchical command structure:

Rank 1 — Original Chief Admin (Michael)

Has absolute authority over all platform operations. Only the Original Chief can: add/delete/reinstate admin staff, promote other admins to Chief, demote Chiefs, and make final override decisions on disputes. If the Original Chief is removed from the system, succession automatically passes to the next Chief by chronological order.

Rank 2 — Promoted Chief Admins

Have authority to handle work orders, settle disputes, approve payouts, and manage compliance. They can respond to messages. They CANNOT delete, reinstate, or demote other staff — that power remains with Rank 1 only. Promoted Chiefs cannot delete each other.

Admin Staff (No Chief Rank)

Can ONLY respond to messages and escalate to chain of command. No authority over disputes, payouts, work orders, compliance decisions, or staff management.

3. Getting Started — First Login & Setup

When your account is created, you will receive:

1. A username (e.g., sarah.tl)
2. A one-time temporary password (8 characters)

Steps to activate your account:

1. Navigate to the admin login page
2. Enter your username and temporary password
3. You will be redirected to the Setup page
4. Set your permanent password (must be strong)
5. Add your email address for notifications
6. Complete your initial setup

NOTE: The temporary password expires after first use. If you lose it before logging in, contact the Chief Admin for a reinstatement (which generates a new temporary password).

4. Admin Dashboard Navigation

The admin dashboard sidebar contains the following sections. You can view most of them for awareness, but your action capabilities are limited to messaging:

Section	Purpose	Your Access
Overview	Dashboard summary with key metrics	View only
Transactions	All escrow transactions	View only
Disputes	Open disputes & AI recommendations	View only — escalate to Chief
Workflow Tracker	Milestone progress across orders	View only
Emmanuel AI	Admin AI assistant	Can use for information
Vendors	Vendor accounts, KYC, tiers	View only
Buyers	Buyer accounts & order history	View only
Compliance	AML/KYC flags	View only — escalate to Chief
Analytics	Revenue & performance charts	View only
Reports	Summary reports	View only
Documents	Archived files & contracts	View only
Messages	User support inbox	FULL ACCESS — Primary duty
Accountability	Shared inbox, action log, overrides	View log, use shared inbox

Settings	Platform configuration	View only
Training Manual	This document	View & download

5. Your Primary Responsibility: Messaging

The Messages section is your main workspace. Here is how the messaging system works:

How Messages Are Routed

All user messages (from buyers and vendors) are routed to a shared inbox. Every admin can see every message. When you open a message thread and respond, you 'claim' that thread. Other admins will see that you are handling it (shown as your alias, e.g., TL-Agent-6835).

Anonymity Protocol

Users NEVER see your real name. They only see a generic 'TrustLock Support' label. Your agent alias (TL-Agent-XXXX) is only visible to other admins on the backend. This protects your identity.

Message Claiming

Once you respond to a thread, it is claimed by you. Other admins can still view the conversation and join if needed, but they will see that you are the primary handler. If you are away, another admin can take over — the system tracks all handoffs.

What to Check For in Messages

1. Transaction status — check if order is locked, shipped, delivered, or disputed
2. User frustration level — respond empathetically, never argue
3. Whether the issue requires escalation (disputes, refunds, compliance)
4. Missing documents or KYC requirements
5. Technical issues vs. policy issues

Response Guidelines

Always be professional and concise. Use clear language. Never promise outcomes you cannot deliver (e.g., 'your money will be released tomorrow'). Instead say: 'I have escalated your case to our senior team. You will be updated shortly.'

NEVER disclose internal processes, admin names, or chain of command structure to users.

6. Escalation Protocol

When you encounter an issue beyond your authority, escalate immediately:

- Step 1: Gather all relevant information (transaction ID, user complaint, screenshots if available)
- Step 2: Use the Shared Inbox in the Accountability tab to flag the issue
- Step 3: Tag the case as 'open' with a clear summary

Step 4: Inform the user that their case has been escalated

Step 5: Monitor the thread for Chief Admin response

Issues That ALWAYS Require Escalation:

- Any dispute or disagreement between buyer and vendor
- Requests for refunds or fund releases
- Compliance flags or suspicious activity
- KYC verification issues
- Payment processing errors
- User threats (legal or otherwise)
- Any action that would modify transaction status

7. What Admin Staff CANNOT Do

This list is exhaustive. Attempting these actions will be blocked by the system and logged:

- Settle or resolve disputes
- Release escrowed funds
- Approve or reject payouts
- Modify transaction status (lock, release, cancel)
- Approve or reject KYC documents
- Override AI recommendations
- Modify compliance flags
- Change vendor tiers or billing plans
- Create or modify work orders
- Access Gas Treasury or blockchain anchoring controls
- Add, delete, reinstate, or manage other admin accounts
- Modify platform settings
- Generate or sign legal documents

8. What Chief Admins CAN Do

For your awareness, Chief Admins (Rank 1 and Rank 2) can:

- All messaging functions (same as you)
- Settle disputes with documented reasoning
- Release or hold escrowed funds
- Approve/reject payouts
- Override AI dispute recommendations (with 48-hour window)
- Review and act on compliance flags
- Approve/reject KYC documents
- Create and manage work orders
- Manage blockchain anchoring and gas treasury
- Generate reports and export data

Rank 1 (Original Chief) additionally can:

- Add/delete/reinstate admin staff

- Promote admins to Chief
- Demote Chiefs back to staff
- Final override on any system decision

9. AI Tools Available to You

TrustLock provides AI-powered tools to assist with your duties. You are encouraged to use them:

Emmanuel AI (Admin AI Assistant)

Location: Emmanuel AI tab in sidebar

Emmanuel is your on-demand AI advisor. You can ask it:

- Transaction status lookups
- Industry-specific compliance requirements
- Risk scoring on vendors or transactions
- Dispute history patterns
- Policy clarifications

Emmanuel has access to 8 analytical tools: `risk_score`, `vendor_health`, `fraud_patterns`, `transaction_timeline`, `compliance_check`, `industry_playbook`, `dispute_history`, and `payout_analysis`.

How to Use Emmanuel Effectively

Be specific in your queries. Instead of 'What is happening with the order?', ask 'What is the current status of transaction TL-2025-0042 and are there any compliance flags?'

Amani AI (Buyer Assistant) & Zawadi AI (Vendor Assistant)

These are user-facing AI assistants. You do not interact with them directly, but knowing they exist helps you understand what users may have already been told before messaging you.

Command Palette (Cmd+K / Ctrl+K)

Press Cmd+K (Mac) or Ctrl+K (Windows) from anywhere in the admin dashboard to search for transactions, documents, users, or navigate quickly. This is a power tool — use it.

10. Shared Inbox Protocol

The Shared Inbox (under Accountability tab) is different from the Messages section:

Messages: Direct communication with users (buyers/vendors)

Shared Inbox: Internal admin communication for case coordination

Use the Shared Inbox to:

- Flag cases that need Chief Admin attention
- Leave notes for other admins on complex threads

- Track which cases are open/closed
- Coordinate handoffs between shifts

11. Action Logging & Accountability

Every action you take on the platform is logged in the Action Log (Accountability tab). This includes:

- Messages sent
- Threads claimed
- Escalations made
- Pages accessed

All actions require a justification if flagged by the system. If you take an action that deviates from standard protocol, the system flags it as a 'deviation' and it is automatically escalated for Chief Admin review.

IMPORTANT: Never attempt to circumvent the logging system. All attempts are tracked and reported to the Chief Admin.

12. Understanding Transactions & Escrow

While you cannot modify transactions, understanding how they work helps you assist users:

Transaction Lifecycle

1. PENDING — Order created, awaiting payment
2. LOCKED — Funds received and held in escrow
3. SHIPPED — Vendor has shipped goods/delivered service
4. DELIVERED — Buyer confirms receipt
5. RELEASED — Funds released to vendor
6. DISPUTED — Either party has raised a dispute
7. KYC_HOLD — Transaction paused pending identity verification (over \$5,000)
8. COMPLIANCE_HOLD — Frozen due to compliance flag

Transaction Types:

Simple: One-time payment, single release

Milestone: Payment split into stages with document gates

Hybrid: Combination of upfront + milestone

13. Understanding Disputes

Disputes are handled EXCLUSIVELY by Chief Admins. Your role:

1. Listen to the user's complaint
2. Document the details clearly
3. Escalate to Chief Admin with full context
4. Inform the user: 'Your dispute has been escalated to our senior resolution team.'

NEVER promise a specific outcome. NEVER suggest who is at fault. NEVER share AI recommendations with users.

14. Compliance & KYC Basics

TrustLock enforces AML (Anti-Money Laundering) and KYC (Know Your Customer) requirements:

- All vendors undergo KYC verification
- Transactions over \$5,000 trigger automatic KYC holds
- Sanctions screening runs on all parties
- Document scanning AI checks for forgery indicators

If a user asks about KYC requirements, direct them to their dashboard's verification section. If they report issues with verification, escalate to Chief Admin.

15. Blockchain Proof Awareness

Every transaction generates blockchain proofs anchored to the Polygon network. These are immutable records that include:

- Escrow lock events
- Fund release events
- Dispute filings and resolutions
- Document attestations
- Milestone completions
- KYC verifications
- Payout confirmations

Users may ask about blockchain verification. Direct them to the proof certificate link provided in their transaction details.

16. Document Management

TrustLock auto-generates several documents during transaction lifecycles:

- Escrow Acknowledgement Forms
- Pre-Order Signatory Contracts
- AML Screening Certificates
- Payout Reconciliation Receipts
- Dispute Evidence Packages

All documents are stored for 7 years minimum for regulatory compliance. You can view documents but cannot modify or delete them.

17. Security & Session Management

Your admin session automatically times out after a period of inactivity. You will be redirected to the login page. This is a security feature — do not attempt to bypass it.

Security Rules:

- Never share your login credentials with anyone
- Never access the admin panel from public/shared computers
- Never screenshot or record the admin panel
- Log out when stepping away from your workstation
- Report any suspicious activity to the Chief Admin immediately
- If your account is compromised, contact the Chief Admin for immediate deletion and reinstatement with new credentials

18. Common Scenarios & Responses

Scenario	Response Template
User asks 'Where is my money?'	'Your funds are securely held in escrow. Let me check the status of your transaction. [Check TX status]
User says 'I want a refund'	'I understand your concern. Refund requests are handled by our senior resolution team. I am escalating this to them now.'
User reports vendor not shipping	'Thank you for reporting this. I can see your order [TX-ID] was locked on [date]. Let me escalate this to our vendor resolution team.'
User asks about KYC hold	'For transactions over \$5,000, identity verification is required by our compliance policy. Please complete your KYC to proceed.'
User threatens legal action	'We take all concerns seriously. Let me escalate this to our senior resolution team immediately. All concerns are handled through our internal channels.'
User asks who they are speaking to	'You are speaking with TrustLock Support. How can I assist you today?' [Never reveal your agent alias]

19. Glossary

Term	Definition
Escrow	Funds held by TrustLock between buyer payment and vendor fulfillment
KYC	Know Your Customer — identity verification requirement
AML	Anti-Money Laundering — regulatory compliance framework
Milestone	A stage in a multi-phase transaction with document gates
TL-ID	TrustLock unique identifier for components and diagnostics
Blockchain Proof	Immutable on-chain record anchored to Polygon network
Gas Fee	Blockchain transaction cost for anchoring proofs
RLS	Row Level Security — database access control system
Agent Alias	Your anonymous identifier visible only to other admins
Deviation	An action that goes against standard protocol or AI recommendation
Override Window	48-hour period for Chief Admin to reverse a dispute decision
Seed Token	Internal platform currency for fee routing
Work Order	Formal task assignment for transaction-related actions
Shared Inbox	Internal admin communication for case coordination
Action Log	Complete audit trail of all admin actions

20. Emergency Procedures

Critical Incident Protocol

If you encounter any of the following, escalate IMMEDIATELY to the Chief Admin:

- Suspected fraud or money laundering
- System security breach or unauthorized access
- User reporting criminal activity through the platform
- Platform downtime or data loss
- Regulatory inquiry or law enforcement contact

Do NOT respond to the user in emergency situations. Simply acknowledge receipt and escalate.

Account Compromise Protocol

If you believe your admin account has been compromised:

1. Contact the Chief Admin immediately through any available channel
2. The Chief Admin will delete your account (voiding all credentials)
3. After investigation, you may be reinstated with fresh credentials
4. All actions during the compromised period will be audited

— End of Training Manual —

For questions about this manual, contact the Chief Admin.